

Educational system resilience is not a crisis-response measure but a structural Retain condition: only a system capable of functioning under pressure can accumulate human capital and prevent its outflow. For Ukraine, where education operates under permanent crisis conditions, investing in systemic educational resilience is a direct investment in countering brain drain.

Educational system resilience is not a crisis-response measure but a structural Retain condition: only a system capable of functioning under pressure can accumulate human capital and prevent its outflow. For Ukraine, where education operates under permanent crisis conditions, investing in systemic educational resilience is a direct investment in countering brain drain.

RETAIN

Learning Under Crisis: How Countries of Eastern Europe, the Caucasus and Central Asia Build Educational System Resilience

This CEDOS analysis examines how GPE partner countries in the region respond to natural disasters, armed conflicts, and public health crises that regularly disrupt educational processes. The key finding is that crises do not merely interrupt learning -- they expose and deepen pre-existing structural deficiencies in education systems. Resilience is framed as a systemic property rather than a situational response. For Ukraine, this context is especially pertinent:

wartime conditions create a permanent crisis state in which the education system must simultaneously function, adapt, and prepare human capital for post-war reconstruction.

3R: Retain-type transaction signal: educational resilience is a foundational condition for human capital accumulation within the country. Without it, reskilling lacks infrastructural grounding, and young competency carriers face structural incentives to emigrate. The signal points to the need for institutional strengthening of the educational environment as a prerequisite for retaining and reproducing human capital.

CEDOS